Complete Guide: Running Python & Git/GitHub Setup

A step-by-step sequence guide for students and beginners

Part 1: Running Python & Preparing for GitHub

- **Step 1: Write and Run Python Code**
  - Open VS Code, create a new file, and save it as `test.py`.
  - Write your code, for example: `print("Python is successfully working!")`.
  - Click the **Play button** (triangle icon) in the top-right corner to run the code and verify the output in the Terminal.
- **Step 2: Initiate Source Control**
  - Click on the **Source Control** icon (the icon with 3 circles and lines) on the left-side panel.
  - Click the blue **"Publish to GitHub"** button.
- **Step 3: Select Files to Include**
  - A dropdown window will appear at the top center of VS Code.
  - Make sure your file (`test.py`) is checkmarked/selected, and click the blue **"OK"** button.

Part 2: Configuring Git Credentials (Fixing First-Time Errors)

- **Step 4: Fix Username and Email Configuration Error**
  - If a popup appears saying *"Make sure you configure your 'user.name' and 'user.email' in git"*, click **Cancel**.
  - Go to your VS Code Terminal at the bottom and run these two commands one by one (press **Enter** after each):

```
git config --global user.name "Your-GitHub-Username"
```

```
git config --global user.email "your-email@example.com"
```

Note: Use the exact email address linked to your GitHub account.

Part 3: Committing and Publishing to GitHub

- **Step 5: Write a Commit Message**
  - In the Source Control tab, click inside the empty **"Message"** text box.
  - Type a short description of what you did, like `"my first commit"`.
- **Step 6: Choose Repository Settings & Publish**
  - Click the blue **"Commit"** button.
  - Name your repository at the top bar. Ensure it is a unique name. If it already exists, pick a new one like `Python-First-Code`.
  - Choose your visibility: select **Public** if you want to showcase it on your portfolio, or **Private** if you want to keep it hidden.
  - Click **"Publish Branch"** to upload the code to GitHub.

Part 4: Updating Existing Code (Pushing Changes)

- **Step 7: Modify and Save Changes**
  - Add or change code inside your `test.py` file.
  - Press **`Ctrl + S`** to save your progress. The Source Control icon will display a counter showing your unsaved updates.
- **Step 8: Automate Staging and Sync**
  - Type a new message in the Source Control text box (e.g., `"added second line"`) and click **"Commit"**.
  - When the popup asks to stage all changes directly, click **"Always"** so you never have to see that prompt again.
  - Click the blue **"Sync Changes"** button to instantly update your repository on the web.

Part 5: Cleaning Up (Deleting Unwanted Repositories)

- **Step 9: Access Repository Settings on Browser**
  - Open your browser, navigate to GitHub, and click on the repository you want to delete.
  - Click on the **Settings** (gear icon) tab located in the horizontal navigation menu.
- **Step 10: Delete via Danger Zone**
  - Scroll all the way down to the bottom of the Settings page to find the red **"Danger Zone"** section.
  - Click **"Delete this repository"** and follow the confirmation prompts.
  - Type the exact repository path requested (e.g., `YourUsername/Repository-Name`) and click the final red confirmation button to permanently delete it.